

Selfish \$\$ **(Resentment)**

I am resentful at my former employer. The cause of this resentment is they eliminated my position. It didn't matter to me what the reason might have been or that others lost their jobs also. What mattered to me is that they fired me with no warning and I was losing my livelihood.

Because of my selfishness, my self-esteem was affected because I did not want to believe they could actually get along without me. **I felt** betrayed by the people I worked for and **felt** like a failure because **my** job had been eliminated instead of someone else's.

Because of my selfishness, my personal relationships were affected because **I felt** everyone judged me because I had been "let go." **I felt** embarrassed and humiliated that somehow it was my fault. **I felt** I had to explain the "unfair" circumstances over and over to family, friends and colleagues and I complained bitterly about the unfairness of my employer to anyone who would listen.

Because of my selfishness, my material security was affected because suddenly I had no income and **I believed** my family could absolutely not survive without the earnings from my job.

Because of my selfishness, my future social ambitions were affected because I would not go anywhere where I might run into people from my former law firm or my law library colleagues because I felt shame. **I believed** they either pitied me or **whispered** I must have somehow deserved what happened.

Because of my selfishness, **I felt** my future security was affected due to the loss of income from my job and **my belief** that I would **never** find another full-time position that paid as much.

No matter what their part was, I took **selfishness** to an extreme. **I felt** sorry for myself and told everyone who would listen to me how unjust and awful they were. **I failed to consider** that eliminating my position was most likely a difficult business decision due to the downturn of the economy and other things outside my control. I became able to accept the idea that "it was not personal." When **I finally stopped blaming** my former employer for my loss of job/income, I was able to re-asses my assets and look for work with a new outlook and healthier attitude.